

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Glossy Ibis

(Scientific Name) *Plegadis falcinellus*Red 2/18/01 upg
(1 photo)

Date(s) of occurrence: 16 April 2000

Number of birds seen: 2 in separate flocks

Location: near Ft. Lyon, Bent County

Length of observation: 15 minutes

Time(s) of observation: morning

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Mark Janos, Tony Leukering, Brandon Percival

Conditions: warm and sunny.

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular and 20 - 60x B & L Elite scope

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 40 - 150 meters

Habitat: Wet grassy area.

Details: While birding in Bent County we found two Glossy Ibis, each in a separate flock of White-faced Ibis. I managed to get some poor video of the first Glossy Ibis before it flew farther away. We did not see the birds together. They looked similar except the first bird was slightly smaller than the White-faced Ibis it was with, while the second was roughly the same size as accompanying White-faced Ibis.

Both birds looked very similar to the 50+ White-faced Ibis they were with. They were both in alternate plumage, characterized by rich purple-chestnut bodies and necks and iridescent glossy green wings. Long decurved bill brownish-olive. Legs dull greenish-maroon, not nearly as bright as of the White-faced Ibis. The second bird had more contrastingly bright knees on duller colored legs. Eye dark. Facial skin dark gray-blue. Narrow pale bluish-white line extending from above eye and facial skin to above bill; similar line of same color from below eye and facial skin to base of bill. Area behind eye dark and the same color as the rest of head. Otherwise, similar to White-faced Ibis.

In flight the first bird had quicker and snappier wingbeats, most likely because of its smaller size.

Both individuals separated from White-faced Ibis by facial skin color, face pattern, eye, leg and bill color.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen hundreds of Glossy and White-faced Ibis and spent a lot of time studying these birds. I have studied most White-faced Ibis in CO, and most Glossy Ibis in NJ and FL.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None.

This report is made from notes made immediately after observation.

Date of written report: 10 February 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.netSignature: **Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)**Reporting Observer's Address: 3465 S Otis Court
City: Lakewood

State: Colorado

Zip: 80227

Photo: Still captured from video. First of two Glossy Ibis seen in field near Ft. Lyon, *Bent*, on 17 April 2000. Glossy Ibis (right bird) pictured White-faced Ibis. It is difficult to see many of the separating characteristics from this photo. See "Details" for complete description.

